PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Student Career Discovery Platform

A career guidance platform for students in grades 9 to 12

Prepared for: The Founder (Educator and Venture Lead)
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Contents

1. Introduction....3
2. Background....3
3. Problem Statement....4
4. Goals, Principles and Scope....5
5. Users and Stakeholders....5
6. Research Summary and Key Insights....7
7. Product Overview....8
8. Functional Requirements....9
9. General Requirements....13
10. Release Plan and Roadmap....13
11. Success Metrics....14
12. Dependencies....14
13. Limitations, Risks and Mitigations....15
14. Next Steps....15
15. Conclusion....15

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of this document

This Product Requirements Document (PRD) sets out what the Student Career Discovery Platform must do, who it is for, and in what order it will be built. It turns the evidence gathered from students, teachers and parents into product decisions, feature requirements, priorities, release stages and success measures, so that the platform build starts from one shared and agreed definition of the product.

The founder has asked for a clear point of view on how each phase of the engagement connects to the next. This document is that connection. The research tells us what the problem is, this PRD states what the product must do about it, and the platform build turns those requirements into a working product.

1.2 Scope of this document

It covers the background to the venture, the problem and the evidence behind it, product goals and principles, the target users, the research insights, product decisions, functional and general requirements, the release plan, success metrics, dependencies, limitations and risks, and the next steps.

1.3 Source documents

This PRD is built on the two documents listed below. Every requirement, figure and target in it traces back to one of them.

Document	Issued by	What it contributes to this PRD
Request for Proposal: Market Intelligence, Experience Design and Platform Build for a Student Career Discovery Venture	The Founder (Educator and Venture Lead)	Founder background, the startup idea, the objective of the engagement, the three phase scope of work, review cadence, final pitch and what the founder is looking for
Career Guidance Platform: Research Report and Product Roadmap	Nishtha Khanna	Findings from three Jotform surveys (35 responses), key insights, product decisions, feature priority, product roadmap, limitations and risks

1.4 Priority levels and reference codes

Feature priorities follow the feature priority set in the research report: **P0** (must have), **P1** (should have) and **P2** (nice to have). Each priority is tied to the demand signal recorded in the surveys.

Requirement tables use short source codes so that every line can be traced: **D** refers to a product decision (Section 7.3), **I** to a key insight (Section 6.3), **S** to a roadmap stage (Section 10) and **RFP** to the Request for Proposal.

2. Background

2.1 The founder

The founder is a career educator with experience across all types of Indian schools, from mainstream to alternative and progressive. She has spent years working closely with teenagers as they face some of the biggest education decisions of their lives. This hands on experience has given her real insight into how teenagers think, where they struggle, and how the systems around them often let them down.

She is not an outside investor following an education technology trend. She has seen the same challenges come up again and again for her students and has decided to create a solution just for them.

2.2 The startup idea

Students in grades 9 to 12 often do not know what they want, yet they have to make important choices about streams, subjects and careers before they are ready. Without good guidance, they rely on parents, teachers, friends or coaching centres. These sources mean well, but their advice can be uninformed, biased or simply not right for the student. The result is decisions based on outside influence instead of what truly fits.

The startup aims to solve this problem. It will work directly with students in this age group, guiding them through a series of activities, tests and evaluations to create a detailed profile of each student's strengths, interests and

preferences. Instead of giving generic advice, it will offer thoughtful recommendations for career paths that truly fit each student, based on real evidence rather than pressure or guesswork.

2.3 Engagement context

The founder asked for the venture to be approached through a full 360° lens and delivered across three sequential phases, ending in a pitch to the founder.

Table 1: Scope of work set out in the RFP

Phase	Focus	What the phase delivers
Phase 1	Market Intelligence and Opportunity	Study the market opportunity, competitive landscape, adjacent players and substitutes, and synthesise the findings into a comprehensive market intelligence and opportunity report for the company
Phase 2	Experience Design	Design an experience for the primary customers applying design thinking principles. This phase carries the widest creative latitude; the intent is to see how the consultant thinks and solves open ended problems
Phase 3	Platform Build	Bring the design to life by building a working platform that implements the defined process, using Claude or any comparable AI tool of the consultant's choosing

Progress is tracked through reviews held twice a week. If the work is well received, the engagement ends in a call with the founder, where everything studied, designed and built is pitched. The founder is looking for rigour in analysis, originality in design, the ability to translate ideas into a functioning product, and a clear point of view on how each phase connects to the next.

2.4 Work completed before this PRD

Five steps of research and product definition were completed before this document was written.

Table 2: Completed project steps

Step	What was done	Output	Status
1. Problem framing	Defined the question: how do students choose careers, and what do teachers and parents need to support them	Three stakeholder groups to research	Complete
2. Research design	Built one questionnaire per group on Jotform (created 17 July 2026), each with 14 to 16 questions	3 live forms	Complete
3. Data collection	Collected responses from all three groups	35 responses: 17 students, 13 teachers, 5 parents	Complete
4. Analysis	Counted answers, averaged the 1 to 5 rating questions, grouped open text into themes and compared the three groups	Findings and insights	Complete
5. Product definition	Turned the insights into product decisions and a roadmap	Product decisions and roadmap, carried into this PRD	Complete, ready for review

3. Problem Statement

3.1 The problem

Students in grades 9 to 12 are asked to choose streams, subjects and careers before they understand their own strengths, interests and preferences. The people around them mean well, but their advice can be uninformed, biased or not right for the student, and schools do not yet give enough structured guidance. Career decisions end up being shaped by outside influence, pressure and guesswork instead of evidence about the student.

3.2 What the research shows

The surveys confirm the problem from all three sides. All 17 students have never taken a career assessment, 41% name not knowing their strengths as their biggest challenge, and 59% rate knowledge of their own strengths and

weaknesses at a flat 3 out of 5. Average student confidence in choosing a career is 3.2 out of 5, with 24% at 1 or 2. Teachers rate student preparedness at 3.1, with 38% at 1 or 2, and 85% say current school programs are only partly sufficient or not sufficient. Every parent says schools give only partial or no guidance, and 80% say lack of trust or credibility would stop them from using a platform.

3.3 The problem in one line

> **Students are ready for guidance, schools are not yet ready to give it. Today, students are choosing careers without a mirror.**

4. Goals, Principles and Scope

4.1 Product goals

1. Give every student a clear picture of their strengths, interests and aptitude through an assessment that is the entry point to the product.
2. Turn assessment results into one living profile per student, shareable with teachers and parents with the student's consent.
3. Offer career recommendations that truly fit each student, explained in plain language and based on evidence rather than pressure or guesswork.
4. Show every student clear steps from their current grade through roadmaps, college information and skill gap analysis.
5. Help teachers guide students with class profiles, discussion guides, a toolkit and a path to counsellors.
6. Give parents a light summary with the roadmap and salary and market context that they can trust.
7. Earn trust at every step by showing how recommendations are made and keeping counsellor review in the loop.

4.2 Guiding principles

- **Build the mirror first, the map second.** Self knowledge comes before planning, so the assessment and profile ship before roadmaps and college information (I1, I7).
- **Make trust a feature, not a footnote.** Explain how each recommendation was made, show the methodology and keep expert and counsellor review in the loop (I4, D4).
- **Speak to the student directly.** Students drive their own decisions; parents and teachers support the decision but do not control it (I2).
- **Help teachers, do not replace them.** Position the product as a tool that helps teachers, not one that replaces them (I5, D6).
- **Lead with fit, show salary as context.** Recommendations explain skill and interest match first (I6, D8).
- **Start early.** Target grades 9 to 11 first, with content built around stream selection decisions (I7, D7).

4.3 Out of scope

The following are deliberately not part of the product, based on the research:

- Generic career advice that is not based on the student's own profile (RFP)
- Replacing teachers or counsellors; the product supports their guidance (I5)
- A heavy parent product; parents get a light summary that is built after the student experience (D5)
- Recommendations led by salary; pay is shown as context only (D8)
- Sharing a student's profile without the student's consent (D2)

5. Users and Stakeholders

The research covered the three groups that shape a school student's career choice. Students are the primary users. Teachers and parents support the decision but do not control it.

5.1 Primary user: students in grades 9 to 12

Table 3: Student survey results (n = 17)

Question	Result
Grade	Grade 10: 41%, Grade 9: 24%, Grade 11: 18%, Grade 12: 18%
Confidence in choosing a career (1 to 5)	Average 3.2. Rated 3: 41%. Rated 4 or 5: 35%. Rated 1 or 2: 24%
Biggest challenge	Do not know my strengths: 41%, lack of information: 29%, too many options: 12%, family expectations, fear of failure, money: 6% each
Who influences the decision most	Myself: 59%, parents: 18%, social media: 12%, friends: 6%, teachers: 6%
Taken a career assessment before	No: 100%
Self description	Helping others: 29%, practical: 24%, analytical, entrepreneurial, creative: 12% each, leadership: 6%, unsure: 6%
Career factors, average rank (1 is best)	Skills 2.35, passion 2.35, salary 2.76, job security 3.88, work life balance 4.53, family expectations 5.12
Knowledge of own strengths and weaknesses (1 to 5)	Average 3.1. Rated 3: 59%
Likelihood to use a recommendation platform (1 to 5)	Average 3.7. Rated 4 or 5: 65%
Most valuable features	College information: 71%, career tests: 65%, roadmaps: 65%, internship suggestions: 65%, mentor sessions: 59%, skill gap analysis: 59%, parent reports: 12%

What students said in their own words: they want real counsellors, not general talks (“To have actual career counsellors who suggest what the student can pursue”); workshops that show many options (“Initiate workshops where students get to know about many career options”); hands on exposure and life skills, such as mandatory micro shadowing programs and lessons on practical things like paying tax; and an expert who can tell them the single most practical first step if they have no idea, which stream or course to pick, and which jobs will stay safe from AI.

5.2 Secondary user: teachers

Table 4: Teacher survey results (n = 13)

Question	Result
Grades taught	Grades 9 and 10: 62%, grade 9 only: 23%, grade 10 only: 8%, grades 10 to 12: 8%
How prepared students are to decide (1 to 5)	Average 3.1. Rated 1 or 2: 38%
Biggest single challenge for students	Family pressure: 23%, lack of information: 15%, fear of failure: 15%, a mix of several: 46%
How often students ask for career advice	Sometimes: 62%, often: 15%, very often: 15%, rarely: 8%
Confidence guiding outside own subject (1 to 5)	Average 3.5. Rated 4: 54%
Skills students struggle with	Time management: 23%, problem solving: 15%, a mix of several: 62%
Are school programs sufficient	Partially: 62%, no: 23%, yes: 15%
Support that would help most	Career guidance toolkits: 23%, partnership with counsellors: 23%, training workshops: 15%, a mix of several: 38%
Structured student profiles would improve discussions	Yes: 100%
Value of an AI assisted platform (1 to 5)	Average 3.2. Rated 4 or 5: 31%. Rated 3: 54%

What teachers asked for in their own words: start guidance earlier, from grade 9; bring in professional counsellors and expert talks; help students match skills and interests through self assessment; and give students verified and relevant information.

5.3 Secondary user: parents

Table 5: Parent survey results (n = 5)

Question	Result
Child's grade	Grade 10: 60%, grade 9: 20%, grade 11: 20%
Confidence the child knows the right path (1 to 5)	Average 4.0
Biggest concern	Lack of guidance: 40%, lack of clarity: 40%, market instability: 20%
How parents help today	Career counsellors: 80%, internet research: 40%, discussions: 20%
Interests versus market trends (1 to 5, 5 is interests only)	Average 4.2
Sought professional counselling	No: 60%, yes: 40%
Do schools give enough guidance	Partially: 60%, no: 40%
Information that would help most	Career roadmaps: 60%, skill gap analysis, salary and market trends, expert mentor access: 40% each, aptitude reports: 20%
Trust in an assessment platform (1 to 5)	Average 4.0. Rated 4 or 5: 80%
What would stop them from using it	Trust and credibility: 80%, lack of awareness: 20%

What parents said in their own words: counsellors often lack quality and knowledge, families drift toward foreign options by default, and guidance is treated as an afterthought instead of being part of the curriculum.

5.4 The three groups side by side

Table 6: Comparison across students, teachers and parents

Theme	Students	Teachers	Parents
Is school guidance enough	No direct question; they ask for real counsellors and workshops	85% say partly or not sufficient	100% say partly or not sufficient
Readiness (average, 1 to 5)	Own confidence: 3.2	Student preparedness: 3.1	Confidence in child: 4.0
Appetite for a platform	Average 3.7; 65% rate 4 or 5	Average 3.2; 31% rate 4 or 5	Trust average 4.0; 80% rate 4 or 5
Main worry	Do not know strengths: 41%	Family pressure and fear of failure	Lack of guidance and clarity: 40% each
Top ask	College information, tests, roadmaps	Structured profiles: 100%	Roadmaps: 60%

6. Research Summary and Key Insights

6.1 Research method

Three questionnaires were built on Jotform on 17 July 2026, one each for students, teachers and parents, with 14 to 16 questions each. In total, 35 responses were collected. The analysis counted answers, averaged the 1 to 5 rating questions, grouped open text answers into themes and compared the three groups.

The forms hold survey data only. No interview transcripts were captured, so the qualitative findings come from the open text answers inside the surveys.

6.2 What the data shows

The charts below summarise the survey results that shape the product the most. Full results for every question are in Section 5.

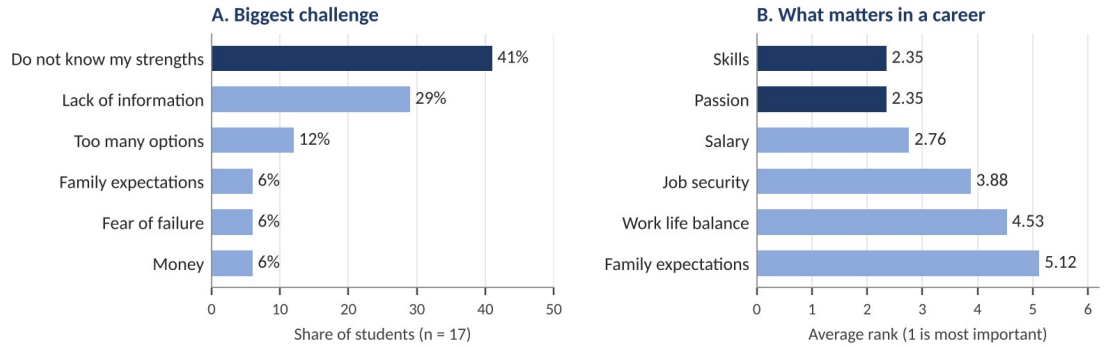


Figure 1: Students' biggest challenge (A) and what they value in a career (B)

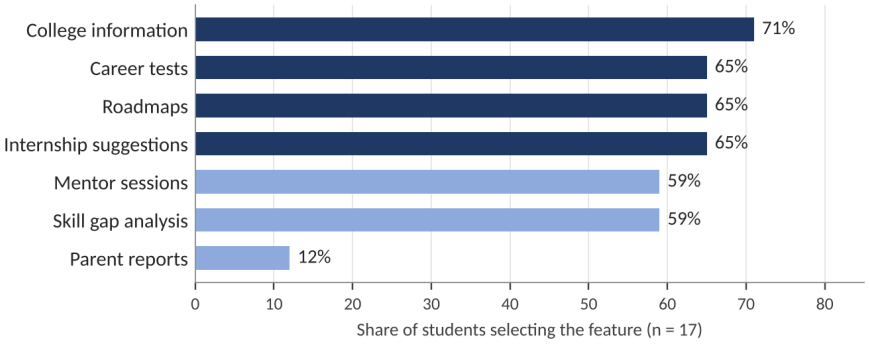


Figure 2: Features students value most in a career platform

6.3 Key insights

1. **The core problem is self knowledge, not information.** Every student surveyed has never taken an assessment, 41% do not know their strengths, and 59% rate their self knowledge at a flat 3 out of 5. Students are choosing careers without a mirror.
2. **Students drive their own decisions, so the product must speak to them directly.** 59% say they influence their own choice most, and only 6% name teachers. Parents and teachers support the decision but do not control it.
3. **Parents are more confident than their children.** Parents average 4.0 on confidence, students average 3.2. With only 5 parents this is a signal, not a proof, but it points to a gap that a shared profile or report could close.
4. **Trust, not interest, is the parent barrier.** 80% of parents would try an assessment platform and 80% name trust and credibility as the thing that could stop them. A recommendation they do not believe is worth nothing.
5. **Teachers want structure more than AI.** All 13 teachers want structured student profiles, but only 31% rate an AI platform at 4 or 5. The product should be positioned as a tool that helps teachers, not one that replaces them.
6. **Skills and passion beat salary.** Skills and passion tie for first in the student ranking, with salary third. Recommendations should lead with fit and show pay as context.
7. **Start early.** 65% of students are in grades 9 and 10, and teachers ask for guidance to begin at grade 9. The best window is before stream selection, not after.

7. Product Overview

7.1 Product vision

A platform that works directly with students in grades 9 to 12, guides them through a series of activities, tests and evaluations, builds a detailed profile of each student's strengths, interests and preferences, and offers career recommendations that truly fit, based on real evidence rather than pressure or guesswork.

> **Build the mirror first, the map second, and earn trust at every step.**

7.2 Core experience

The product unfolds in the same order as the roadmap. The student starts by understanding themselves, then plans a path, and the people around them are brought in once the student experience is in place.

Table 7: Core experience flow

Step	What the student experiences	Product components	Stage
1. Discover yourself	Takes a short strengths, interests and aptitude assessment at onboarding	Career and aptitude assessment	S1
2. See your profile	Gets one living profile built from the assessment results	Student profile	S1
3. Understand your fit	Sees a first set of career recommendations with plain language reasons, led by skill and interest match	Career recommendations; methodology page	S1
4. Plan the path	Sees clear steps from the current grade, college information and skill gaps	Roadmaps; college information; skill gap analysis	S2
5. Get support	Profile is used by teachers in guidance conversations; books counsellor or mentor sessions; receives internship suggestions	Teacher view; counsellor and mentor booking; internship suggestions	S3
6. Involve family	Parents receive a simple summary with the roadmap and salary and market context, with expert reviewed recommendations	Parent summary; salary and market trends	S4

7.3 Product decisions based on the research

Table 8: Product decisions (D1 to D8)

#	Decision	Evidence	What it means for the product
D1	Make the assessment the entry point	100% of students never took one, 41% do not know their strengths, career tests chosen by 65%	Onboarding starts with a short strengths, interests and aptitude assessment
D2	Turn results into a living student profile	100% of teachers want structured profiles	One profile per student, shareable with teachers and parents with the student's consent
D3	Build the plan layer next: roadmaps, college information, skill gap analysis	Chosen by 71%, 65% and 59% of students; roadmaps also the top parent ask at 60%	After the assessment, every student sees clear steps from their current grade
D4	Make trust a feature, not a footnote	80% of parents cite trust and credibility as the barrier	Explain how each recommendation was made, show the methodology, add expert and counsellor review
D5	Build a light parent view, not a heavy parent product	Students rank parent reports lowest at 12%; parents want roadmaps and market trends	A simple summary with roadmap, salary and market context, built after the student experience
D6	Build a teacher view with toolkits and counsellor links	Toolkits and counsellor partnerships are the top teacher needs at 23% each	Class level dashboard, discussion guides and a path to book counsellors
D7	Target grades 9 to 11 first	65% of students are in grades 9 and 10, and all 13 teachers teach grade 9 or 10	Content and pilots built around stream selection decisions
D8	Lead with fit, show salary as context	Skills and passion rank 2.35, salary 2.76	Recommendations explain skill and interest match first

8. Functional Requirements

Requirements are grouped by feature. Each feature shows its priority, the demand signal behind it, the users it serves, the release stage in which it ships and, where one is set, the success measure attached to it.

8.1 Career and aptitude assessment

Priority: P0, must have | **Release:** S1 Discover (Q4 2026) | **Users:** Students

Demand signal: Career tests chosen by 65% of students; aptitude reports by 20% of parents; 100% of students have never taken an assessment. **Success measure:** 80% of pilot students finish the assessment and 70% rate it useful at 4 or 5.

The assessment is the entry point to the product. It addresses the biggest gap found in the research: students do not know their own strengths, and none of them has ever been assessed.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR1.1	Onboarding must start with a short assessment covering strengths, interests and aptitude	D1
FR1.2	The assessment must guide students through a series of activities, tests and evaluations	RFP
FR1.3	Assessment results must feed the student profile	D2
FR1.4	The platform must publish what the assessment does and does not measure	S1 to S5
FR1.5	The first version must be piloted with students in grades 9 to 11	D7, S1

8.2 Student profile

Priority: P0, must have | **Release:** S1 Discover (Q4 2026) | **Users:** Students; teachers and parents with the student's consent

Demand signal: 100% of teachers say structured student profiles would improve guidance discussions.

The profile turns assessment results into something the student, their teachers and their parents can use. It is also the shared record that could close the gap between parent confidence (4.0) and student confidence (3.2).

ID	Requirement	Source
FR2.1	The platform must create one profile per student from the assessment results	D2
FR2.2	The profile must capture each student's strengths, interests and preferences in detail	RFP
FR2.3	The profile must be a living profile, not a one time result	D2
FR2.4	The profile must be shareable with teachers and parents only with the student's consent	D2
FR2.5	Teachers must be able to use the profile in a guidance conversation	S3

8.3 Career recommendations

Priority: Part of the S1 release scope | **Release:** S1 Discover (Q4 2026), improved with usage data in S5 | **Users:** Students

Demand signal: Core promise of the venture; skills and passion rank ahead of salary for students.

Recommendations are the reason the venture exists: career paths that truly fit each student, based on real evidence rather than pressure or guesswork.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR3.1	The platform must give each student a first set of career recommendations	S1
FR3.2	Each recommendation must come with plain language reasons	S1
FR3.3	Recommendations must explain skill and interest match first and show salary as context	D8, I6
FR3.4	Each recommendation must explain how it was made	D4
FR3.5	Counsellor review must stay in the loop	D4, S1 to S5
FR3.6	Recommendations must be specific to the student's profile, not generic advice	RFP
FR3.7	Recommendation quality must improve with usage data	S5

8.4 Methodology and trust page

Priority: P0, must have | **Release:** S1 Discover (Q4 2026) | **Users:** Parents, students and teachers

Demand signal: 80% of parents name trust and credibility as the barrier to use.

Trust is the deciding factor for parents. A recommendation they do not believe is worth nothing, so trust is built into the product from day one.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR4.1	The platform must have a methodology page that shows how the assessment works and how recommendations are made	D4, S1
FR4.2	The page must state what the assessment does and does not measure	S1 to S5
FR4.3	The platform must show that expert and counsellor review is part of the process	D4
FR4.4	Information shown to students must be verified and relevant	Teacher themes

8.5 Career roadmaps

Priority: P0, must have | **Release:** S2 Plan (Q1 2027) | **Users:** Students and parents

Demand signal: Roadmaps chosen by 65% of students and 60% of parents (the top parent ask). **Success measure:** 60% of pilot students open their roadmap a second time.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR5.1	After the assessment, every student must see clear steps from their current grade	D3
FR5.2	Every pilot student must get a roadmap	S2
FR5.3	The roadmap must be included in the parent summary	D5, S4

8.6 College information

Priority: P1, should have | **Release:** S2 Plan (Q1 2027) | **Users:** Students

Demand signal: College information chosen by 71% of students, the most valued feature.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR6.1	The platform must provide college information as part of the plan layer that follows the assessment	D3
FR6.2	College information must be verified and relevant	Teacher themes

8.7 Skill gap analysis

Priority: P1, should have | **Release:** S2 Plan (Q1 2027) | **Users:** Students and parents

Demand signal: Chosen by 59% of students and 40% of parents.

Teachers report that students struggle with time management (23%) and problem solving (15%), with 62% naming a mix of several skills.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR7.1	The platform must show each student's skill gaps as part of the plan layer that follows the assessment	D3

8.8 Internship suggestions

Priority: P1, should have | **Release:** S3 Support (Q2 2027) | **Users:** Students

Demand signal: Chosen by 65% of students; students also ask for hands on exposure such as micro shadowing programs.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR8.1	The platform must suggest internships to students	S3

8.9 Teacher toolkit and dashboard

Priority: P1, should have | **Release:** S3 Support (Q2 2027), piloted in 2 to 3 schools | **Users:** Teachers

Demand signal: Career guidance toolkits and counsellor partnerships are the top teacher needs at 23% each; 100% want structured profiles. **Success measure:** 70% of pilot teachers use the profiles in a guidance conversation.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR9.1	Teachers must have a class level dashboard with class profiles	D6, S3
FR9.2	The teacher view must include discussion guides and a toolkit	D6, S3
FR9.3	The teacher view must give teachers a path to book counsellors	D6
FR9.4	The teacher view must be positioned as a tool that helps teachers, not one that replaces them	I5

8.10 Mentor and counsellor sessions

Priority: P1, should have | **Release:** S3 Support (Q2 2027) | **Users:** Students and parents

Demand signal: Mentor sessions chosen by 59% of students; expert mentor access by 40% of parents.

Students asked for actual career counsellors who suggest what they can pursue, and listed the questions they want an expert to answer: the most practical first step if they have no idea, which stream or course to pick, and which jobs will stay safe from AI. Parents note that counsellors often lack quality and knowledge, which ties this feature to the trust requirements in Section 9.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR10.1	Students must be able to book counsellor and mentor sessions	S3

8.11 Salary and market trends

Priority: P2, nice to have | **Release:** S4 Involve family (Q3 2027) | **Users:** Parents and students

Demand signal: Chosen by 40% of parents; 20% of parents name market instability as their biggest concern.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR11.1	The platform must show salary and market trends as context, not as the lead of a recommendation	D8, S4

8.12 Parent summary

Priority: P2, nice to have | **Release:** S4 Involve family (Q3 2027) | **Users:** Parents

Demand signal: Students rank parent reports lowest at 12%; parents want roadmaps (60%) and market trends (40%). **Success measure:** 4 in 5 pilot parents rate trust at 4 or 5.

ID	Requirement	Source
FR12.1	Parents must receive a simple summary with the roadmap and salary and market context	D5, S4
FR12.2	The parent summary must be built after the student experience	D5
FR12.3	Recommendations shown to parents must be expert reviewed	S4
FR12.4	The summary must be shared only with the student's consent	D2

Parent features should be locked only after a second round of parent research, since the current parent sample is 5 responses (see Section 13).

8.13 Feature priority summary

Table 9: Feature priority and release stage

Feature	Demand signal	Priority	Stage
Career and aptitude assessment	Students 65%, parents 20% (aptitude reports)	P0, must have	S1
Student profile	Teachers 100%	P0, must have	S1

Feature	Demand signal	Priority	Stage
Career roadmaps	Students 65%, parents 60%	P0, must have	S2
Methodology and trust page	Parents 80% (barrier)	P0, must have	S1
College information	Students 71%	P1, should have	S2
Skill gap analysis	Students 59%, parents 40%	P1, should have	S2
Internship suggestions	Students 65%	P1, should have	S3
Teacher toolkit and dashboard	Teachers 23% each for toolkit and counsellors	P1, should have	S3
Mentor and counsellor sessions	Students 59%, parents 40%	P1, should have	S3
Salary and market trends	Parents 40%	P2, nice to have	S4
Parent report	Students 12%	P2, nice to have	S4

9. General Requirements

These requirements apply to every feature and every release stage.

- **Trust and transparency.** Trust runs through every stage of the roadmap. The platform must show how recommendations are made, keep counsellor review in the loop, and publish what the assessment does and does not measure (S1 to S5, D4).
- **Consent and sharing.** A student's profile is shared with teachers and parents only with the student's consent (D2). This keeps the product speaking to the student directly, since 59% of students say they influence their own decision most (I2).
- **Language and presentation.** Recommendations must give plain language reasons (S1) and lead with skill and interest fit, with salary shown as context (D8). Information given to students must be verified and relevant, as teachers asked.
- **Content focus.** Content and pilots are built around stream selection decisions for grades 9 to 11 (D7). Teachers ask for guidance to start at grade 9, and the best window is before stream selection, not after (I7).
- **Build approach.** The platform must be a working product that implements the defined process, built using Claude or any comparable AI tool of the consultant's choosing (RFP). Only 31% of teachers rate an AI platform at 4 or 5, while all of them want structured profiles, so the product is presented to teachers as a tool that gives them structure (I5).

10. Release Plan and Roadmap

The roadmap runs in five stages, starting from October 2026. Targets are suggested starting points to be confirmed before each stage begins.

Table 10: Release stages

Stage	Timing	What ships	Why now	Milestone and suggested target
S1 Discover	Q4 2026	Assessment, student profile, first set of career recommendations with plain language reasons, methodology page	Fixes the biggest gap and builds trust from day one	Pilot with grade 9 to 11 students. Target: 80% finish the assessment and 70% rate it useful at 4 or 5
S2 Plan	Q1 2027	Career roadmaps, college information, skill gap analysis	Students and parents both ask for a clear path	Every pilot student gets a roadmap. Target: 60% open their roadmap a second time
S3 Support	Q2 2027	Teacher view with class profiles, discussion guides and toolkit; counsellor and mentor booking; internship suggestions	Teachers want structure and counsellor partnerships	Pilot in 2 to 3 schools. Target: 70% of pilot teachers use the profiles in a guidance conversation
S4 Involve family	Q3 2027	Parent summary with roadmap, salary and market trends; expert reviewed recommendations	Parents need proof before they trust it	Target: 4 in 5 pilot parents rate trust at 4 or 5

Stage	Timing	What ships	Why now	Milestone and suggested target
S5 Scale	Q4 2027 onward	School partnerships, outcome tracking, recommendation quality improved with usage data	Move from pilot to a repeatable model	Number of schools onboarded and student retention to grade 12

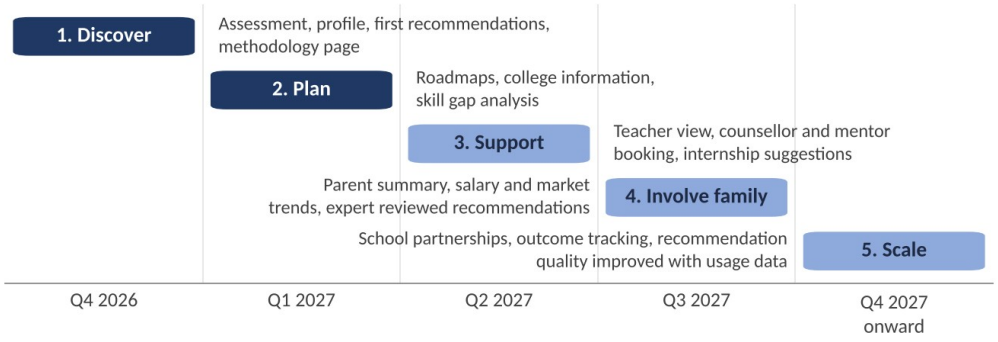


Figure 3: Release stages from Q4 2026 onward

11. Success Metrics

Each stage has one milestone measure. The research baseline shows where things stand today, so progress can be judged against real numbers.

Table 11: Success metrics by stage

Stage	Metric	Target	Research baseline
S1	Pilot students who finish the assessment	80%	17 of 17 students have never taken a career assessment
S1	Pilot students who rate the assessment useful at 4 or 5	70%	Likelihood to use a recommendation platform: average 3.7, 65% at 4 or 5
S2	Pilot students who get a roadmap	Every pilot student	Roadmaps requested by 65% of students and 60% of parents
S2	Pilot students who open their roadmap a second time	60%	Not measured yet
S3	Pilot teachers who use the profiles in a guidance conversation	70%	100% of teachers say structured profiles would improve discussions
S4	Pilot parents who rate trust at 4 or 5	4 in 5	Trust in an assessment platform: average 4.0, 80% at 4 or 5; 80% name trust as the barrier
S5	Schools onboarded	Tracked	Not measured yet
S5	Student retention to grade 12	Tracked	Not measured yet

12. Dependencies

Table 12: What the product depends on

Dependency	Needed for	Stage
Counsellors and experts	Counsellor review of recommendations, counsellor and mentor booking, a path for teachers to book counsellors, expert reviewed recommendations for parents	S1 to S4
Pilot students and schools	Grade 9 to 11 pilot students for the assessment; 2 to 3 schools for the teacher view; school partnerships at scale	S1, S3, S5
Student consent	Sharing any profile with teachers or parents	All
A second parent research round	Locking parent features	Before S4

Dependency	Needed for	Stage
Usage data	Improving recommendation quality and tracking outcomes	S5

13. Limitations, Risks and Mitigations

Table 13: Limitations of the research and how to handle them

Issue	Why it matters	How to handle it
Small samples, especially 5 parents	Parent findings are directional only	Run a second parent round before locking parent features
No interview data in the forms	The qualitative layer rests on open text answers	Add interview notes if they exist, or run 5 to 8 short interviews per group
Parent answers look inconsistent	80% say counsellors are how they help, yet 60% say they never sought counselling	Clarify the question wording in the next round
Teacher answers are spread across many options	46% to 62% of several answers fall in the mix of everything category, so single winners are weak	Use theme level conclusions, not exact percentages
School, city and board are not captured	Results may not generalise	Add school type and location fields to the next version of each form

14. Next Steps

1. Review this PRD with the founder through the twice weekly review cadence.
2. Confirm the suggested stage targets before each stage begins.
3. Start the S1 Discover pilot with grade 9 to 11 students.
4. Run a second parent research round before locking parent features.
5. Add interview notes if they exist, or run 5 to 8 short interviews per group.
6. Add school type and location fields to the next version of each form, and clarify the parent question wording on counselling.
7. Pitch everything studied, designed and built to the founder in the final call.

15. Conclusion

The research points in one direction. Students want help and are open to using a platform, but none of them has ever taken a career assessment. Teachers say school guidance is not enough and want structured student profiles. Parents are willing to use an assessment platform, but only if they can trust it.

The product answers this in order: an assessment and a living profile first, a clear plan second, then support for teachers and a light view for parents, with trust built into every stage.

> **Build the mirror first, the map second, and earn trust at every step.**